

calls this feeling, this absolute certainty deep inside, ‘the knowing’,² and explains that she discovered it by just shutting herself inside a cupboard until the only voice left in her head was her own. Every cupboard in my home is stuffed to the brim with all kinds of crap, and I’d rather not be crushed by an avalanche of old baby clothes and emergency chairs in the pursuit of knowing myself, but I have found meditation to be really helpful when it comes to learning to trust my gut and weeding out unwanted distractions.

When your brain is constantly whirring at a hundred miles per hour, the thought of achieving any kind of meditative state instead of doing something more *active*, especially when you’re used to thinking of money in such purely practical terms, might seem counterproductive. But readying the ground for better financial confidence and clearer, quicker decision-making will save you a lot of time and uncertainty later on.

Meditation and mindfulness are not things that come naturally to me, nor to anybody else that I know. I suppose if we all found it easy to clear our minds, we probably wouldn’t need to practise meditation in the first place. The most unlikely people are probably the ones who need it the most – just think about Don Draper in *Mad Men* and that final shot of him, eyes closed, tension finally released just a little. Sometimes these practices can feel a little bit silly or alien, especially if we’re doing them in pursuit of something as practical and seemingly unrelated as better money management, but re-